3. Pensions continued

Defined benefit plans continued

i) Characteristics and risks associated with the Plans continued

GMP equalisation

On 26 October 2018, the High Court ruled on the Lloyds Bank GMP inequalities case. In response to this, an allowance of £3.1 million was included on the balance sheet at 31 December 2018 to make provision for the estimated costs arising from the judgement. This past service cost was charged to the profit and loss account in 2018 and related to the Staff Plan. There was no impact on the Cash Plan.

Over the year to 31 December 2019, the Trustees and the Company have not taken any formal decisions over the process. The calculation of the allowance as a proportion of the liabilities included within the IAS 19 figures is therefore unchanged. As a result of changes in market conditions, the allowance is now £3.2 million. The difference has been charged to profit and loss account reserves during the year as an experience gain/loss.

Further information on the GMP equalisation, including the considerations in the calculation, are disclosed in the Company's 2018 Annual Report.

ii) Amounts in the financial statements

The assets and liabilities on the balance sheet are as follows:

	2019 £ million	2018 £ million
Schemes in net asset position		
UK defined benefit pension plan – Staff Plan	**7.8**	1.1
UK defined benefit pension plan – Cash Plan	**1.0**	0.9
	8.8	2.0
Schemes in net liability position		
UK unfunded plan	**(0.5)**	(0.5)
Net pension plan surplus on the balance sheet	**8.3**	1.5